



ART BY RYAN YEE

INTRODUCTION

This is a fan-made adventure module using the D&D 5e system. All resources for running this adventure can be found [here](#). All illustrations and names used from Magic: The Gathering, along with all D&D terms and rules, are properties of Wizards of the Coast. This is only a fan creation, not in any way made for sale.

Download the basic rules for FREE at [here!](#)

Innistrad is a setting steeped in gothic horror themes and makes liberal use of horror tropes. Werewolves hunt within the forests, vengeful spirits haunt the places of their grisly deaths, hedonistic vampires feast on humans at their leisure, and Frankenstein-like mad scientists create abominations stitched together from corpses. All these classic horror stories are merged together to create a unified campaign setting that is much more than the sum of its parts, an amazing and compelling backdrop for epic storytelling.

LEARNING ABOUT INNISTRAD

The vast majority of Innistrad's backstory can be found in the [A Planeswalker's Guide to Innistrad](#) series on Wizards' official site. The entire series does a great job summarizing everything you, the DM, need to know about the setting. Read it over once and then have it open for reference when running a game and you'll be set.

The first part of the series, [Introduction](#), can work as a handout to give to players whose characters are native to Innistrad, as it contains mostly general knowledge – though you may omit bits of information at your discretion.

Players may have access to additional information based on which of the four provinces their characters hail from (if any). If a character lives in Kessig, you may want to give that player access to some of the information in [A Planeswalker's Guide to Innistrad: Kessig](#) as well, but double check to see if there's any information you as the DM would rather withhold. You'll likely want to omit the section about werewolves, as such information probably isn't known by average folk, and even some parts may be a mystery to werewolves themselves.

Characters that aren't locals may also discover information about places and people with appropriate Intelligence checks, such as Intelligence (Religion) to recall lore about the Church of Avacyn, or Intelligence (Nature) to recall lore about the basic geography of Stensia.



ADAPTING INNISTRAD TO D&D

Innistrad is very compatible as a D&D setting. Almost everything in the setting functions well under the D&D system.

CLASSES

The classes present in the *Player's Handbook* not only fit seamlessly into the setting, nearly all of them are explicitly mentioned in the official lore:

- Paladins and Clerics would be exemplary soldiers and leaders within the Church of Avacyn, blessed with the capability to wield the Light and spread the Church's influence to the most dangerous corners of the world. They would most likely start their careers in Thraben, the seat of the Church.
- Rangers and Druids are both tied to the forests that cover most of Innistrad. Rangers are often hunters and wilderness guides, while Druids act as curators of the forests and mediators of ancient forest spirits. Both tap into the ancient, primal powers of nature that have been forgotten by most folk since the rise of the Avacyn Church.
- Bards and Rogues are drawn to more densely populated cities, such as the ones found in the

province Nephalia, to earn coin from their respective trades. Bards travel from town to town as entertainers while Rogues often use their talents in criminal activities.

- Wizards pursue academic interests and are often well-respected scholars, astronomers, and alchemists. In the pursuit of knowledge, some require isolation in a quiet village or off somewhere on their own, while others seek colleagues in Nephalia's larger towns to combine research
- Barbarians often come from the province Kessig, a reflection of the untamed spirit of the land and its people. Some scholars point out similarities between a barbarian's rage and the ferocity of werewolves.
- Fighters come from all walks of life. These disciplined martial masters are often hired muscle for a wide variety of tasks, or do the work of the Avacyn Church as cathars, the militia of the Church.
- Sorcerers seem to manifest their powers out of nowhere, though there are rumors of the magic coming from their blood, or being permanently changed after exposure to raw magic.
- Warlocks can be anyone willing to make the taboo pact for power: Skirsdag cultists gladly enter them with the fiends they worship, those in touch with nature make pacts with the powerful fey spirits living in the forests, and most rare are the mad few that acquire a dark patron from beyond Innistrad itself. Warlocks must keep their pacts a secret or else face persecution, especially from the Church of Avacyn.
- Monks are a little tougher to fit, but it wouldn't be a huge stretch to say that perhaps most are trained as cathars for the Avacyn Church or are brought up in remote villages.

RACES

One issue that you must decide upon is what races to allow from the *Player's Handbook* as natives of Innistrad. The official lore seems to indicate that elves have gone extinct long ago, and that other fantasy staple races like dwarves and halflings do not exist in this world.

There are a few ways to interpret the absence of non-human races. The most straightforward option would be to only allow human characters as natives of Innistrad. If you choose this option, it's strongly recommended that you let the players use the [Player's Guide to Innistrad: Human Variants](#) by redditior /u/Nihilates; the guide allows for mechanical variety within the human race and serves as a wonderful primer for players to learn about the province that their character hails from.

Another option would be to treat non-human natives as exceptionally rare: elves live in small communities deep

within forests, using cunning magics to keep themselves isolated from the outside world. Tieflings could be the result of sadistic experiments carried out by the demon-worshipping Skirsdag cultists – in fact, there is at least one official human/devil hybrid in the lore already: the planeswalker Tibalt. With a little bit of creativity you can fit any PHB race into Innistrad, but any non-human would certainly be a shock to the human locals they come across.

RELIGIONS

Another possible issue is what religions to allow. The majority of Innistrad's citizens worship the angel Avacyn, while minor sects pray to demons, and others give homage to woodland spirits. Do the natives of Innistrad have knowledge of other gods such as Bahamut and Pelor? Again, it's up to you, the DM, to figure out what to allow in your version of Innistrad. Just remember there's always a solution.

INNISTRAD IN THE D&D UNIVERSE

In the universe of *Magic: The Gathering*, Innistrad is its own separate plane, and the only known outsiders are planeswalkers. If you wish to bring Innistrad into the D&D

universe, just plop it into the Material Plane as its own world, like *Forgotten Realms* and *Greyhawk* are. Visitation from outsiders would still be rare (much like the odd planeswalker visit) but it would allow outsider PCs with different races/religions to enter the land with the help of a portal or some advanced magic.

If we go a little further with this idea, the gothic horror doom and gloom that pervades all of Innistrad could be the influence of the Shadowfell; perhaps that shadowy plane has an unusually strong presence/overlap on this world. That's why the sun shines dimmer, the spirits of the dead are more restless, and everything is all-around dark and sinister compared to other worlds in the Material Plane.

THE TRUTH ABOUT THE MOON

Let's take things one step further. What if this strong tie to the Shadowfell came from a specific source? A source that is tied to many of Innistrad's supernatural happenings, dampening protective wards and empowering both werewolves and vampires? Yes, Innistrad's link to the Shadowfell is the moon.

The Innistrad moon is a massive portal to the Shadowfell plane. No one remembers what sinister entity constructed this link between planes, but the world of Innistrad was set to be consumed utterly by the Shadowfell. The deity



that saved Innistrad from being swallowed up by the Shadowfell has similarly been lost to history.

This god could not close the immense portal, but managed to block off and imprison the portal at the cost of the deity's life. The god's corpse engulfs the portal as a massive desert of silver. The barrier of silver stops the Shadowfell from consuming the world, but does not block its influence entirely. You can see an imprint of the long-forgotten god on the moon to this day – it's the heron on the moon's surface.

This explains the seemingly paradoxical nature of Innistrad's moon: the portal to the Shadowfell inside of the moon empowers evil creatures, while the outside surface of silver empowers good. A full moon is when the portal to the Shadowfell is largest and is consequently when werewolves are strongest, yet blessed silver from the moon is the most effective at defeating them.

RUNNING THE ADVENTURE

Army of the Damned is an adventure for four characters of 1st level. During the course of the adventure, the characters will advance to 5th level. You can keep track of experience by writing down the experience gained per event, which is provided by the module. Alternatively, you can choose the milestone experience system and level up when the adventure calls for it.

To properly run this adventure, you will need *Monster Manual* for D&D 5e. The combat statistics of monsters and NPCs in this adventure will be cited to the appropriate page. For example, Jeleva is a **vampire spellcaster** (MM p298), which means you will find her combat statistics in *Monster Manual* page 298. New monsters will have their statistics provided in APPENDIX B.

Similarly, magic items found over the course of this adventure will have their page in the *Dungeon Master's Guide* cited. New items will have their statistics provided in APPENDIX A.

The aforementioned [Planeswalker's Guide to Innistrad](#) should be read to get a feel for the adventure's setting. All other information will be provided here in the module.

ADJUSTING DIFFICULTY

The combat events are tuned for four characters of the appropriate level (starting at level 1), following the combat difficulty guide outlined in *Dungeon Master's Guide*.

If for any reason you wish to strengthen/weaken the combat encounters, it's highly recommended that you use an encounter builder such as [Kobold Fight Club](#). These builders use the calculations outlined in *Dungeon Master's Guide* and will help you adjust the difficulty of combat by adding/removing monsters to reach the

desired difficulty.

For example, **3 zombies** (MM p316) are a Hard challenge for four level 1 PCs. If you have five level 1 PCs instead, that same encounter becomes a Medium challenge. You can bump the difficulty back to Hard by adding an additional zombie to the encounter.

With your handy online encounter builder, tuning combat difficulty to your personal playgroup is a quick and painless process.

ADVENTURE BACKGROUND

HUMANITY'S PERIL

The archangel Avacyn, the central figure of the Church of Avacyn and the main conduit of holy magic on the plane, hasn't been seen over the last few seasons, and her absence shows. Since Avacyn has disappeared, prayers have not spared remote villages from werewolf attacks as they once did. Holy symbols have not stopped vampires from preying on travelers in the high mountain passes. The dead are not protected from tampering by ghoullcallers and flesh-animating alchemists called skaberen. With the power of holy magic waning, humanity is being pushed into a corner by an encroaching darkness that threatens to consume them.

Only a select few elders in the Church, including Mikaeus, the ruling Lunarch, know what has happened to Avacyn; the archangel is trapped within the Helvault after a desperate struggle with the demon Griselbrand. To save Avacyn (if she is even alive) would require shattering the Helvault and releasing hundreds of years' worth of captured demons imprisoned within the silver prison with her, a risky move that may doom the plane utterly.

One Hope

Mikaeus and a handful of his most trusted advisors hatched a desperate plan: they believe that an artifact in the Church's possession, a mystical tuning fork, holds the key to retrieving Avacyn from the Helvault without releasing the demons trapped with her. Not understanding how to wield the artifact themselves, the elders have secretly delivered the fork to a musical prodigy in Stensia named Katarina Brunn, hoping her talents can unlock its power while the Church tries to maintain order in the world.

Mikaeus knows that the secret demon-worshipping cult, the Skirsdag, have human members embedded within Thraben in all levels of the church, nobility, and the trades; the Lunarch believed it would be safer if Katarina studied the artifact in her home town of Shadowgrange, far away from the Skirsdag's influence. The province of Stensia has

plenty of its own dangers, however.

VOLDAREN'S LESSON

Katarina Brunn led the local militia of Shadowgrange, having trained as a paladin in her youth, even joining the ranks of the Riders of Gavony for a time. As impressive as her martial and leadership abilities were, it was her reputation of being a musical prodigy that made the Acacynian Church elders decide to select her to unlock the mysteries of the tuning fork artifact. Indeed, she was making great progress into figuring out the artifact.

Shadowgrange is one of the bleakest places in all of Innistrad. Aside from their own local members, the people are isolated from the Church of Avacyn's influence. Shadowgrange is situated deep in the heart of Stensia, surrounded by vampire estates that view humans as cattle, and is mostly cut off from the outside world. The villagers are fiercely passionate about their lifestyles and have immense pride in their traditions. This is mostly a coping mechanism to hide the truth – they are paranoid and fearful of their situation. Villagers disappear with a grim regularity, usually as a meal for vampires, and the

people have been conditioned for generations to do nothing about it.

There were murmurs of change in the past few years, however. Katarina and her fiancée, an alchemist named Siegfried, led a movement to defend themselves from the vampires and other horrors in the night. They bolstered the town's defenses and tried to convince the villagers to fight. For a while, their efforts were successful – until Avacyn disappeared, and the holy wards around the village began to falter.

Two months ago, while Katarina was deep in her experiments with the artifact, vampires from Voldaren Manor entered the village. The vampires were preparing to celebrate the disturbing three-day holiday called Court of the Vampire Queen, and came to collect their unfortunate "Queen" – Katarina, the troublemaker. Katarina, Ralph, and Siegfried fought the vampires alone. The trio pleaded and begged with the villagers to help, but their friends and neighbors all stood by, frozen in fear. In the end, Ralph was killed, Katarina was taken, and Siegfried was convinced by his love to flee and keep the artifact safe.

ART BY IGOR KIERYLUK





REVENGE OF THE DAMNED

Siegfried was devastated with what happened. He and Katarina's family dedicated their lives to serve and protect the people of Shadowgrange, only to be betrayed by them. In a fit of rage, grief, and despair, he left the village, vowing vengeance on all of Katarina's murderers.

The alchemist has taken up residence in the abandoned Maurer Estate. There he pursues the darker side of alchemy, the necro-alchemy of producing skaabs. Siegfried has teamed up with ghoulcaller Rinelda Smit, and together they have a mad plan to build an army of skaabs and ghouls, taking the fight to the Voldaren estate itself.

To build an army of undead requires many corpses. Siegfried has a decent supply, but he'll need more, hundreds more to dare challenge the Voldaren family. The skaberen has turned his eyes towards Shadowgrange: the villagers damned so many with their cowardice. They damned all those that disappear in the night with no retaliation, all those that begged for help, including his

beloved Katarina, who devoted her life to help them.

If the cowards refuse to fight the vampires in life, they'll fight them in death.

OVERVIEW

Army of the Damned is divided into four parts.

In Part 1, "Into Stensia," the adventurers are on the road to the village of Shadowgrange, entering the province of Stensia through the Kruin Pass and now journeying into the inner valley via the Hofsattel Pass towards Shadowgrange. During this treacherous journey, the adventurers may come across deadly foes and potential allies, some of these encounters laying hooks for short adventures in part 2.

In Part 2, "Shadowgrange," the characters arrive in Shadowgrange to find the village in a state of unrest after a brazen vampire attack. The adventurers must enter the mayor's haunted house to retrieve the Church's holy relic. They can also investigate the mystery of the abandoned

alchemy shop and help various locals with smaller problems.

In Part 3, “Night of the Dead,” the characters must deal with approaching undead threat led by ghoulcaller Rinelda. They can lead a defence or evacuation of the village. Once the zombies have been addressed, the adventurers can continue on their main mission of retrieving the artifact from Siegfried.

In Part 4, “Into the Farbog,” the characters travel through the farbog towards Maur Estate where Siegfried resides, wading through spirits and deadly monsters.

In Part 5, “The Perfect Storm,” the characters infiltrate Maur Estate, making their way past its vile defenses until confronting Siegfried in his laboratory, where the mad scientist is putting the finishing touches on his ultimate creation.

ADVENTURE HOOKS

You can let players invent their own reasons for visiting Shadowgrange, or they can use the following backgrounds as an easy way to create characters with compelling ties to the events of Army of the Damned.

Below is a list of bonds that applies to any background that players select or create. You can replace or augment some or all of the options in your chosen background with one or more of the bonds.

BOND (D8)

1. The Church of Avacyn has hired you to make contact with Katarina Brunn, a musical prodigy living in Shadowgrange, whom they have not heard from in months. You must find her and/or retrieve an artifact that was under her care.
2. A letter has arrived summoning you to Shadowgrange. Your cousin, Siegfried Reinholdt, has fled from his home in Shadowgrange under mysterious circumstances, and the deed to his property has passed to you. Whatever you choose to do with the shop, you must travel to Shadowgrange to sign the necessary papers.
3. You have infiltrated the ranks of the demon-worshipping Skirsdag cult. The cult has found out about a secret plan that the Church of Avacyn is carrying out, something involving an artifact being held by a woman named Katarina living in Shadowgrange. You are under orders to investigate this artifact.
4. Sielda Reishaf, an elder of the Avacyn Church and your foster parent, has entrusted you with an important mission: travel to Shadowgrange and find Katarina Brunn. If she is missing, then retrieve the artifact she was holding, a so-called “tuning fork.”

5. The holy tomb of Saint Traft, one of the most righteous and celebrated cathars to walk the land, is located in Shadowgrange. You’ve decided to make a holy pilgrimage to the saint’s tomb, where it’s said visitors occasionally receive aid in the form of prophecy and omens.
6. Every few nights, you have a strange sequence of apocalyptic dreams where the holy city of Thraben is overrun by fiends and undead. Each time, the dream ends with you holding a strange object in your hand and a silver monument shattering in front of you, releasing a flood of light that cleanses the city. You feel a strange compulsion to travel to Shadowgrange, convinced that the object of your dreams is there.
7. You have a secret. You were once a Skirsdag cultist, but at the end of your life you tried to change your ways for good. With your dying breath, you prayed to the moon for redemption. A vision came to you in the shape of a silver heron. It told you to find an artifact named the Strionic Resonator in Shadowgrange and free Avacyn. You awoke in a new body, your memories of your former life but a dim shadow. Only the vision with the silver heron remains in your mind with perfect clarity.